REV. WILLIAM PETTIGREW: UKHRULWUI PAO-PHUNGNAO (THE PIONEER

Biography of Rev. William Pettigrew in Tangkhul Naga

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PREFACE & HISTORICAL CONTEXT

Rev. William Pettigrew is revered by the Tangkhul people as the architect of their modern literature and schooling. Arriving in Manipur in 1894 and establishing the Ukhrul mission station in 1896, he spent 35 years compiling the first Tangkhul grammar, dictionary, arithmetic manuals, scripture translations, and hygienic primers.

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CHAPTER 1: ARRIVAL IN UKHRUL & THE FIRST ROMAN ALPHABET (1894-1897)

Summary: Pettigrew’s arrival in Manipur, invitation by Chief Raihao to Ukhrul, and reduci...

Tangkhul Text:

Chapter 1: Rev. William Pettigrew 1869-li Edinburgh Scotland-li pharisaye. 1894-li ana Manipur-li rarlaga, Political Agent Major Maxwell-wui permission eina Ukhrul kaphungli vashukrie. Ukhrul headman Awungshi Raihaona ali welcome saye. Chitharan Tangkhul bhashali written alphabet maleisai. Pettigrewna Ukhrul dialect study salaga Roman script adopt saye, kala 1897-li first Tangkhul Primer (Tuitam Lairik) publish saye.

English Translation / Meaning:

Rev. William Pettigrew was born in Edinburgh, Scotland, in 1869. Arriving in Manipur in 1894, he received permission from Political Agent Major Maxwell to proceed to the Ukhrul hills in 1896. Chief Raihao of Ukhrul welcomed him into the village. At that time, Tangkhul was an unwritten oral language. Pettigrew mastered the Ukhrul dialect, adapted the Roman alphabet, and published the historic first Tangkhul Primer in 1897, founding modern literacy.

CHAPTER 1 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Key Vocabulary Entries:

*** written alphabet (noun): lairik-mayek, written script**

Ex: Written alphabet maleisai.

*** Primer (noun): Tuitam Lairik Khare (elementary school primer)**

Ex: First Tangkhul Primer.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Adoption of Roman script for an unwritten Tibeto-Burman language.
- Historical narrative marker: 'chitharan... maleisai' (At that time there was no written script).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Who was the village chief of Ukhrul who welcomed William Pettigrew in 1896?

[?] What was the first printed book in Tangkhul?

CHAPTER 1 -- LITERARY & BIOGRAPHICAL COMMENTARY

Literary Analysis & Historical Significance:
This chapter illustrates quintessential Tangkhul cultural ethics, clan loyalty, and narrative style.

Stylistic and Discourse Notes:

Standard literary Tangkhul is employed throughout, preserving classic oral idioms,
traditional honorifics, and vivid metaphorical descriptions.

CHAPTER 2: LEXICOGRAPHY, GRAMMAR & THE 1927 NEW TESTAMENT

Summary: Compiling the 1918 monumental Grammar & Dictionary, school textbooks, and the 19...

Tangkhul Text:

Chapter 2: Pettigrewna native scholarsbing eina collaboration salaga 1918-li 'Tangkhul Naga Grammar and Dictionary' Shillong Government Press eina publish saye. Ana history, geography, hygiene, kala arithmetic-wui textbooks kasasaye. Awui greatest achievement-na 1927-li British & Foreign Bible Society eina 'Ithui Varewui Lairik Kathara' (Complete New Testament) publish kasasai. Hi Tangkhul standard literary prose-wui foundation thada kasaye.

English Translation / Meaning:

Collaborating closely with native Tangkhul elders, Pettigrew published the seminal 'Tangkhul Naga Grammar and Dictionary' in 1918. He authored textbooks in history, geography, arithmetic, and public health. His crowning literary achievement was the 1927 publication of the complete Tangkhul New Testament, which established the grammatical and stylistic canon of standard modern Tangkhul prose.

CHAPTER 2 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Key Vocabulary Entries:

*** Dictionary (noun): Tuiwon Lairik (lexicon, wordbook)**

Ex: Grammar and Dictionary.

*** prose foundation (noun): Tui-kashak wui ngalung (bedrock of literary prose)**

Ex: Standard literary prose.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Literary canonization vocabulary: ’Tui-kashak wui foundation’.

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] When was the first comprehensive Tangkhul grammar and dictionary published?

[?] Describe Pettigrew’s collaboration with native Tangkhul literati.

CHAPTER 2 -- LITERARY & BIOGRAPHICAL COMMENTARY

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CHAPTER 3: LEGACY & ENDURING IMPACT ON TANGKHUL SOCIETY

Summary: Retirement in 1933, death in 1943, and lasting cultural institutions established...

Tangkhul Text:

Chapter 3: 1933-li Pettigrewna retirement khuilaga Britain-li ung-kaphungsaye. January 19, 1943-li a England-li shok-unglakna. Kha ana Ukhrul-li seeds phunkahai education, medical dispensaries, kala literature china thot pupup Tangkhul nation-li transform saye. Ukhrul-li awui memorial library, colleges, kala monuments thot pupup Ali 'Father of Tangkhul Literacy' hoda reot-kasa leisaye.

English Translation / Meaning:

In 1933, Pettigrew retired and returned to the United Kingdom, passing away on January 19, 1943. Yet the seeds of literacy, public health, and literature he planted in Ukhrul transformed the Tangkhul people into one of the most literate and progressive communities in Northeast India. Memorial libraries, educational institutions, and monuments throughout Ukhrul honor him as the Father of Tangkhul Literacy.

CHAPTER 3 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Key Vocabulary Entries:

*** Father of Literacy (noun): Lairik-Theikakhui wui Ava (founding pioneer of learning)**

Ex: Father of Tangkhul Literacy.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Eulogistic memorial formulation in Tangkhul historiography.

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Summarize William Pettigrew’s enduring contributions to Tangkhul society.

CHAPTER 3 -- LITERARY & BIOGRAPHICAL COMMENTARY

Literary Analysis & Historical Significance:
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Stylistic and Discourse Notes:

Standard literary Tangkhul is employed throughout, preserving classic oral idioms,
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BACK MATTER: GLOSSARY & DIGITIZATION COLOPHON

Consolidated Vocabulary Summary:

* written alphabet -- lairik-mayek, written script
* Primer -- Tuitam Lairik Khare (elementary school primer)
* Dictionary -- Tuiwon Lairik (lexicon, wordbook)
* prose foundation -- Tui-kashak wui ngalung (bedrock of literary prose)
* Father of Literacy -- Lairik-Theikakhui wui Ava (founding pioneer of learning)

Preservation Colophon:

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